

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Vulnerability and Emerging Threat Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer specialising in vulnerability management, emerging threat analysis, and security operations across large enterprise environments. With over five years of progressive experience, I have built and led vulnerability management programmes using industry-leading tools including Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and Nessus — delivering risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking at scale. I have strong hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel (formerly Azure Sentinel) as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing analytics rules, Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries, and threat hunting content mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am equally experienced in threat hunting, security operations monitoring, and incident response, and I bring a structured, intelligence-led approach to identifying and mitigating emerging threats before they materialise into incidents. I thrive in environments where security is taken seriously and where I can contribute both technical depth and strategic thinking to protect complex, high-value organisations.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera BAS, Nessus — programme design, scanning, risk-based prioritisation, stakeholder reporting
- **Emerging Threat Intelligence:** MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat intelligence integration; adversary tradecraft analysis; Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) using Pentera
- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (Azure Sentinel) — workspace design, data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks, KQL-based threat hunting; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven hunting across endpoint, cloud, identity, and email telemetry; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hunting methodologies
- **Security Operations Monitoring:** Alert triage and investigation; Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbook authoring; CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and XDR
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; senior escalation lead; post-incident review and lessons-learned reporting
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the vulnerability management programme across a hybrid cloud and on-premises estate, using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS to identify, prioritise, and track remediation of vulnerabilities based on risk to the organisation
- Conduct Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises using Pentera to continuously validate security control effectiveness and identify emergent attack paths aligned to real-world adversary techniques
- Perform proactive threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry, developing KQL-based hunting queries and detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK emerging threats
- Monitor and analyse security events across SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and cloud security platforms; triage and investigate alerts, distinguishing emerging threats from false positives

- Author and maintain the organisation's threat intelligence-informed incident response playbooks in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK threat actor profiling
- Serve as senior escalation lead for complex security incidents, conducting end-to-end investigation and post-incident review
- Present vulnerability management metrics and emerging threat briefings to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and senior leadership, translating technical risk into business impact
- Collaborate with infrastructure and cloud teams to ensure timely remediation of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities, tracking progress against agreed Service Level Agreements (SLAs)
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Designed and operated the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking resolution across the estate
- Developed and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM analytics rules and KQL threat hunting queries to identify anomalous behaviour and emerging threat patterns across cloud, endpoint, and email data sources
- Conducted proactive threat hunting exercises, leveraging MITRE ATT&CK intelligence to formulate hypotheses and hunt across CrowdStrike Falcon and Sentinel telemetry
- Investigated SIEM and EDR alerts, performing root-cause analysis and coordinating containment and remediation activities
- Authored threat intelligence-informed incident response playbooks, ensuring consistent response procedures mapped to known adversary techniques
- Monitored threat intelligence feeds and emerging vulnerability disclosures, assessing organisational exposure and recommending mitigations
- Managed Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA enforcement, hardening identity controls to reduce the attack surface

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Performed vulnerability assessments across infrastructure and application layers, coordinating remediation with development and infrastructure teams
- Monitored security alerts for anomalous or threatening activity and supported incident investigation and containment
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance including risk assessments, security policy review, and access control audits
- Maintained awareness of emerging threats and security advisories, communicating relevant risks to the security team

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Established a mature, risk-based vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, enabling prioritised remediation aligned to real-world threat intelligence and reducing critical exposure across the estate
- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously stress-test security controls against emerging attack techniques, providing the CISO with evidence-based assurance of control effectiveness
- Developed a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL hunting queries and Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules, improving detection coverage for emerging threat actor techniques
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification, directly remediating vulnerability findings and demonstrating compliance with the UK Government's cybersecurity baseline
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, providing comprehensive endpoint and identity threat visibility
- Built a CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM detection engineering capability, creating custom detections mapped to emerging MITRE ATT&CK techniques and significantly reducing dwell time

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000–80,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)